• Panchayati Raj System, Constitution Amendments and Schedules

31. Consider the following statements :

1. The minimum age prescribed for any person to be a member of Panchayat is 25 years.
2. A Panchayat reconstituted after premature dissolution continues only for the remainder period.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b): A candidate for the seat of Member or Sarpanch of Gram Panchayat must be a registered voter in the electoral roll of the Gram Panchayat. A candidate can not be disqualified if he is less than 25 years but more than 21 years.

Every Panchayat, unless, sooner dissolved under any law for the time being in force, shall continue for five years from the date of appointment. A panchayat constituted upon the dissolution of a Panchayat before the expiration of its duration shall continue only for the remainder of the period for which the dissolved panchayat would have continued under clause (1) had it not been dissolved.

ECONOMY

• Economic Planning and National Income/Budget

32. Regarding 'Atal Pension Yojana', which of the following statement is/are correct ?

1. It is a minimum guaranteed pension scheme mainly targeted at unorganized sector workers
2. Only one member of a family can join the scheme.
3. Same amount of pension is guaranteed for the spouse for life after subscriber's death.

Select the corect answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : Atal Pension Yojana (APY) is a government-backed scheme in India targeted at the unorganized sector. It was originally mentioned in the 2015 Budget speech by Finance Minister Arun Jaitley in February 2015. It was formally launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 9th May, 2015 in Kolkata.

Under the APY, the subscriber would receive the fixed pension of 1000/2000/3000/4000/5000 per month at the age of 60 years, depending on their contributions, which itself would vary on the age of joining the APY. The minimum age of joining APY is 18 years and the maximum age is 40 years. Therefore, the minimum period of fixed pension would be guaranteed by the government.

- Atal Pension Yojana (APY) is open to all bank account holders who are not members of any statutory social security scheme.

So, (2) is wrong.

- As per the Ministry of Finance, " The spouse of the subscriber shall be entitled to receive the same pension amount as that of the subscriber until the death of the spouse. After the death of both the subscriber and the spouse, the nominee of the subscriber shall be entitled to receive the pension wealth, as accumulated till age of 60 years of the subscribe". So, clearly (3) incorrect.

33. There has been a persistent deficit budget year after year. Which action/actions of the following can be taken by the Government to reduce the deficit ?

1. Reducing revenue expenditure
2. Introducing new welfare schemes
3. Rationalizing subsidies
4. Reducing import duty

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (c): Unnecessary revenue expenditure bloats the fiscal deficit, and since it forms the majority of government spending, its reduction has a very large effect on the fiscal deficit. So, (1) is correct.

- It will further increase the fiscal deficit. So, (2) is incorrect.
- Subsidies are a major component of government spending and their reduction will cut down the fiscal deficit. So, (3) is correct
- It reduces tax revenues and thus increases fiscal deficit. So, (4) is incorrect.

34. Which one of the following is a purpose of 'UDAY', a scheme of the Government ?

(a) Providing technical and financial assistance to start-up entrepreneurs in the field of renewable source of energy.
(b) Providing electricity to every household in the country by 2018
(c) Replacing the coal-based power plants with natural gas, nuclear, solar, wind and tidal power plants over a period of time.
(d) Providing for financial turnaround and revival of power distribution companies.

Ans. (d) : It is the Ujwal DISCOM Assurance Yojana, where DISCOMs stands for Distribution companies (electricity) that are state-owned and suffering huge financial losses, mis-governance, low tariff rates etc. The scheme aims at their financial turnaround and revival.

35. Which of the following is/are included in the capital budget of the Government of India ?

1 Expenditure on acquisition of assets like roads, buildings, machinery etc.
2. Loans received from foreign governments.
3. Loans and advances granted to the States and Union Territories.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d): The main items of the capital budget are receipts and expenditure for capital (financial) gains. It also includes loans raised by Government from the public, Reserve Bank and other parties and from foreign Government bodies. It also includes capital expenditure on acquisition of assets like land, buildings, machinery, equipment etc. and loans and advances granted by central Government to state and union territory government, government companies, corporations and other parties.

36. 'Rashtriya Garima Abhiyaan' is a national campaign to–

(a) rehabilitate the homeless and destitute persons and provide then with suitable sources of livelihood.
(b) release the sex workers from their practice and provide them with alternative sources of livelihood.
(c) eradicate the practice of manual scavenging and rehabilitate the manual scavengers
(d) release the bonded labourers from their bondage and rehabilitate them.

Ans. (c): Campaign was started in 2001 known as 'Rashtriya Garima Abhiyaan' (National Campaign for Dignity and Elimination of Manual Scavenging) has proven to be a very innovative and effective program to eliminate manual scavenging practice. The campaign has liberated 11,000 women manual scavengers in various parts of India and urged them to give up this caste-based, unconstitutional practice. In its efforts campaign attain social, economic, political and cultural rehabilitation of manual Scavenger.

37. With reference to 'Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana', consider the following statements :

1. Under this scheme, farmers will have to pay a uniform premium of two percent for any crop they cultivate in any season of the year.
2. This scheme covers post-harvest losses arising out of cyclones and unseasonal rains.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b): Farmers premium has been kept at a maximum of 2 percent for food grains and oilseeds and upto 5 percent for horticulture and cotton crops. So, it is different for different crops. So statement (1) is incorrect.

- Post- Harvest Losses coverage is available only upto a maximum period of two weeks from harvesting for those crops which are allowed to dry in cut and spread condition in the field after harvesting against specific perils of cyclones and cyclonic rains and unseasonal rains. So, statement (2) is correct.

38. With reference to 'Stand Up India Scheme', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Its purpose is to promote entrepreneurship among SC/ST and woman entrepreneurs.
2. It provides for refinance through SIDBI.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) : Stand up India scheme facilitates bank loans between 10 Lakh and 1 core to at least one Scheduled Caste (SC) or Scheduled Tribe (ST), borrower and at least one woman per bank branch for setting up a green field enterprise. This enterprise may be in manufacturing, services, as the trading sector. In the case of non-individual enterprises, at least 51% of the shareholding and controlling stake should be held by either and SC/ST or woman entrepreneur. The scheme is anchored by the department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Financial Services, Ministry of Finance. So, option (1) is correct.

- It provides for refinance window through Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI) with an initial amount of Rs. 10,000 crore .

So option (2) is correct.

39. 'Mission Indradhanush' launched by the Government of India pertains to–

(a) Immunization of children and pregnant women
(b) Construction of smart cities across the country
(c) India's own search for the Earth-like planets in outer space
(d) New Educational policy